Workflow Automation

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Exp 6 – Workflow Automation using Deluge

Aim

To automate a business process in the Event Registration application built on Zoho Creator by configuring form-based, approval-based, and schedule-based workflows using Deluge, such that predefined actions (such as notifying customers, routing records for approval, and running scheduled reports) are triggered automatically without requiring any manual intervention.

Procedure

Step 1: Open the Event Registration application in Zoho Creator and navigate to the application builder to add a new component.

Step 2: From the "Create New Component" screen, select Workflow as the component type to create an automation from scratch.

Step 3: On the trigger-selection screen ("When do you want to run your action?"), choose the "On a form event" option, since the automation must respond to changes made on the Registration Form.

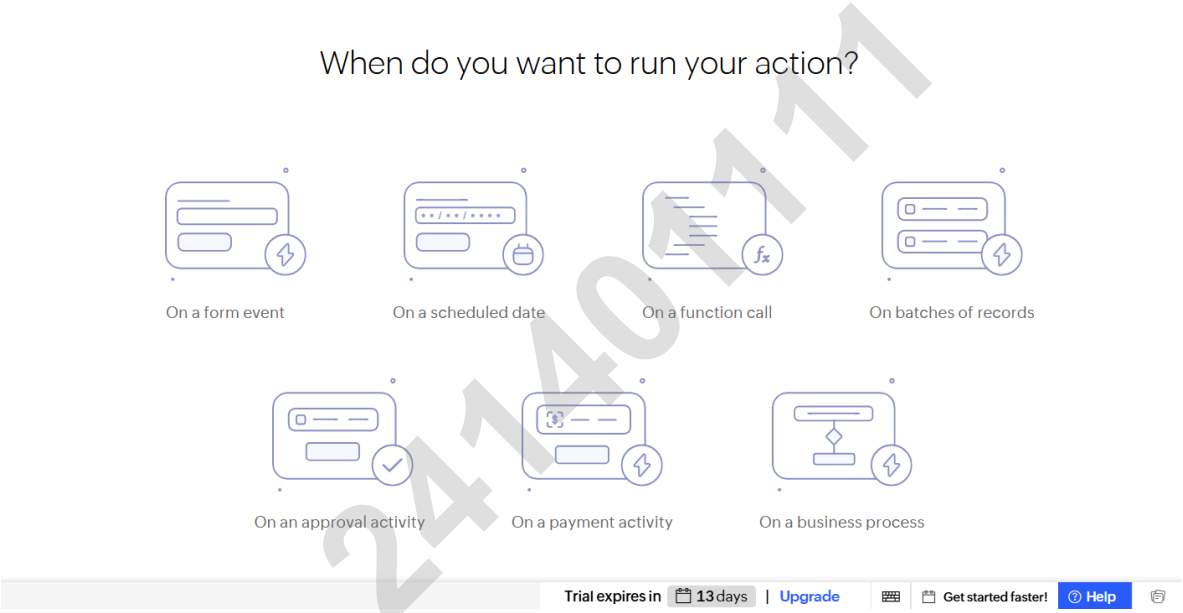


Fig. 1 – Choosing "On a form event" trigger

Step 4: On the workflow configuration screen ("Run workflow on any event in the form"), select the Registration Form, choose the Record Event as Created and the Form Event as Successful form submission, name the workflow "Notify customers", and click Create Workflow.

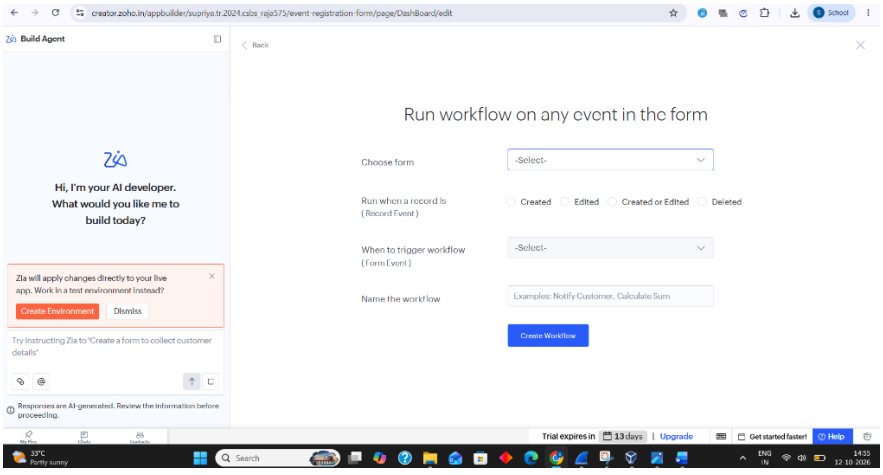


Fig. 2 – Configuring the "Notify customers" workflow

Step 5: Inside the workflow builder, add the required actions under the "Execute without condition" block: a Send Mail action addressed to ${Email_Address}, followed by a Show Message action displaying "Data added successfully!!" to confirm the submission to the registrant.

Step 6: Create a second workflow of type Approval, named "approval", and add a Level 1 Approver (CEO). Under both the Approve and Reject branches, add a Send Mail action addressed to ${approver.submitter} so the registrant is informed of the outcome of the review.

Step 7: Create a Custom Schedule named "Run" under the Schedules tab to explore time-based automation, and configure it to trigger at a fixed date and time.

Step 8: Once created, the workflows appear under Form workflows, Approvals, and Schedules respectively, attached to the Event Registration application, and their status is verified in each case.

Output

The workflow automation was configured and verified across the different automation modules available under the Workflow tab of the Event Registration application, as shown below.

1. Form Workflow – Notify Customers

A form workflow named notify customers was created, triggered on Created → Successful form submission. Its configured actions send a mail to ${Email_Address} and display the success message "Data added successfully!!", confirming that the Deluge-based actions run automatically whenever a new registration record is submitted.

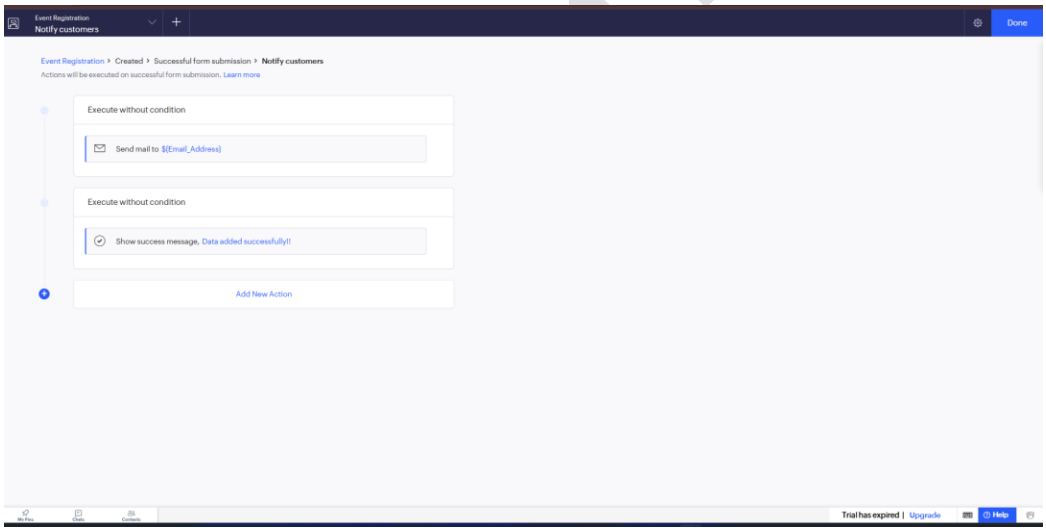


Fig. 3 – Configured actions of the "Notify customers" form workflow

2. Approvals – Request Review

Under Workflow → Approvals, a workflow named approval is listed with 2 Actions, set to run On review, with its Status shown as Enabled. Opening the workflow shows a Level 1 Approver (CEO) with both an Approve and a Reject branch, each of which sends an email to ${approver.submitter}, demonstrating that approval-based automation was successfully configured so that registration records can be routed for review as part of the process.

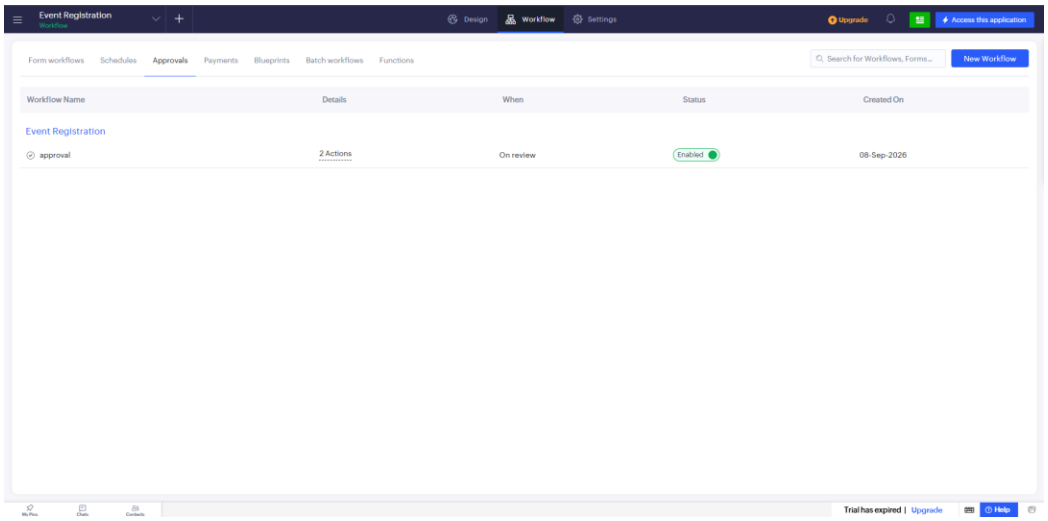


Fig. 4 – Approval workflow "approval" listed as Enabled, running "On review"

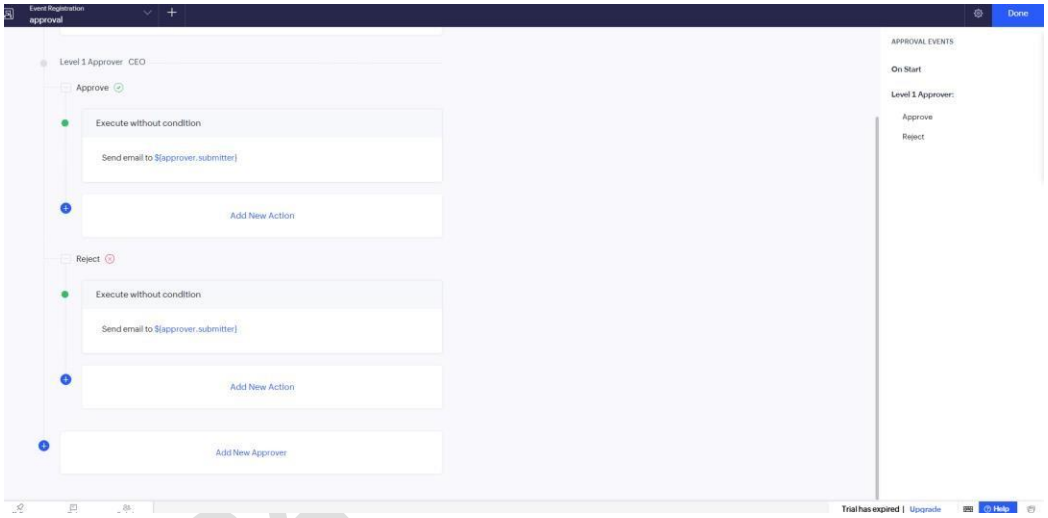


Fig. 5 – Level 1 Approver (CEO) with Approve and Reject actions

3. Schedules – Custom Schedule

A custom schedule named Run was created under the Schedules tab with 1 Action, configured to execute on 15-Sep-2026 at 11:35:38. Its status is shown as Disabled, indicating that time-based (scheduled) automation was also explored and configured, though not activated for regular execution.

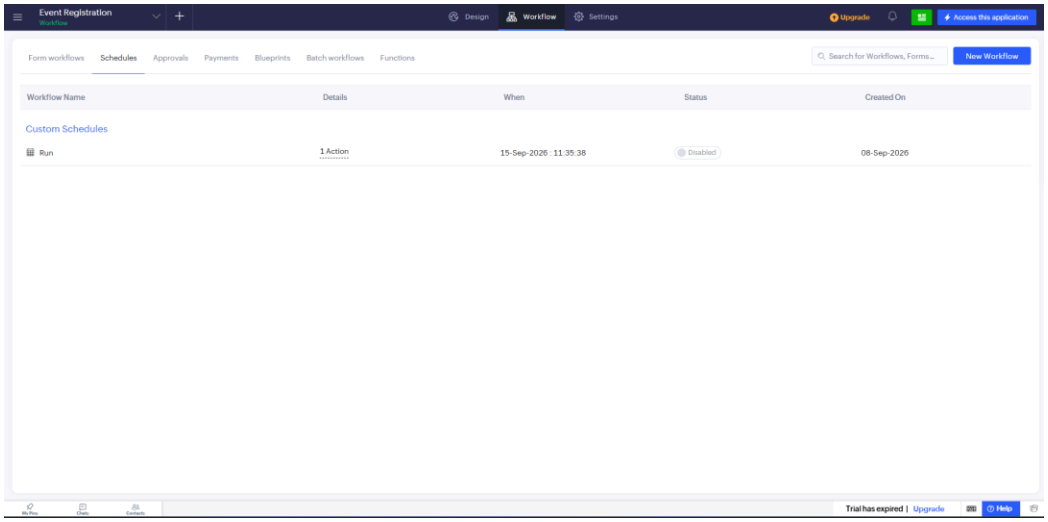


Fig. 6 – Custom schedule "Run" listed under Schedules (Disabled)

Result

Workflow automation was successfully implemented and verified in the Event Registration application using Zoho Creator's Deluge-based workflow builder. A form-event workflow ("notify customers") that emails the registrant and displays a success message, an approval workflow ("approval") that routes records to a Level 1 Approver (CEO) and notifies the submitter of the outcome, and a custom schedule ("Run") were all created and verified, together demonstrating that business processes in the application can be automated to run without manual intervention, whether triggered by form events, review stages, or scheduled times.

Across all three modules, the application moved from a purely manual, form-driven process to one where every stage of a registrant's journey – submission, confirmation, review, and reporting – is handled by the platform itself. Because each workflow is scoped to a specific event (record creation, an approval decision, or a clock trigger), the automation remains predictable and easy to extend: additional actions such as SMS alerts, calendar invites, or payment reminders can be appended to any of the existing blocks without disturbing the others.

Learning Outcomes

This experiment provided hands-on experience with the complete lifecycle of building low-code automation in Zoho Creator, from selecting a trigger to verifying the deployed workflow. The key takeaways are summarised below.

- **Trigger selection:** Understood how Zoho Creator classifies automation into distinct categories – form events, scheduled dates, function calls, batch operations, approvals, payments, and business processes – and how to choose the correct trigger for a given use case.
- **Record vs. form events:** Learned to differentiate between a Record Event (Created, Edited, Created or Edited, Deleted) and a Form Event (such as Successful form submission), and how combining the two determines exactly when a workflow fires.
- **Deluge scripting:** Practiced writing simple Deluge actions – sendmail, alert/show-message, and email-to-approver – and binding dynamic form fields such as ${Email_Address} and ${approver.submitter} directly into those actions.
- **Approval-based automation:** Configured a multi-level approval process with dedicated Approve and Reject branches, each carrying its own notification logic, illustrating how business processes with human decision points can still be automated end-to-end.
- **Scheduled automation:** Created and inspected a custom schedule, understanding how time-based triggers are configured, listed, and enabled or disabled independently of form and approval workflows.
- **Verification and monitoring:** Verified each automation from the Workflow tab (Form workflows, Approvals, and Schedules sub-tabs) by checking the number of configured actions, the trigger condition, and the Enabled/Disabled status, reinforcing the importance of testing automation before relying on it in production.

Overall, the exercise reinforced how low-code platforms let a developer replace repetitive manual tasks – sending confirmation emails, routing approvals, and generating periodic reports – with a small set of visually configured, event-driven rules, significantly reducing development time while keeping the logic transparent and easy to maintain.

4. Verification – Approval Summary

The completed registration record was verified from the application's Approvals module. The Completed Tasks list confirms that the 'Event Registration' request was reviewed, and the Approval Summary panel displays the submitted record details alongside the Approval History, which shows the request as approved.

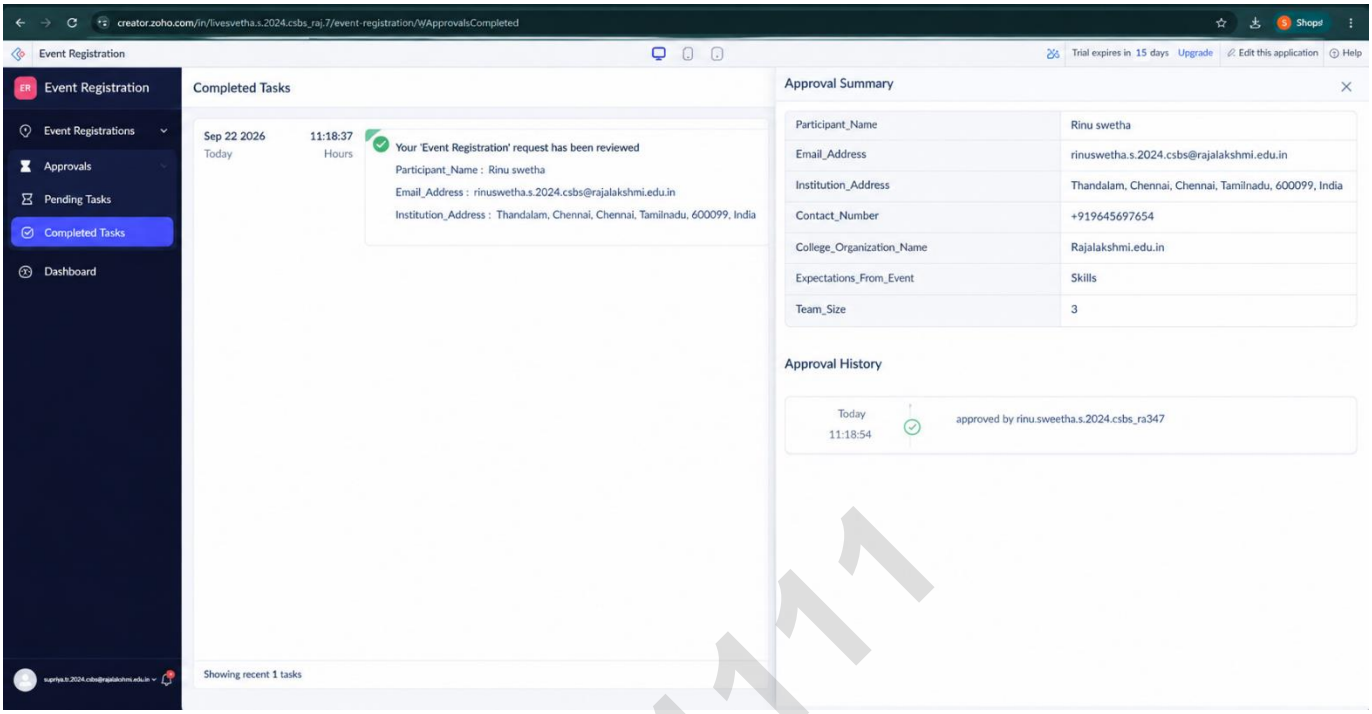


Fig. 7 – Approval Summary showing the reviewed and approved 'Event Registration' request

The approval outcome was further confirmed through the registrant's inbox: the notification email from notifications@trial.zohocreatormail.com, triggered by the Send Mail action in the Approve branch, states that the request has been approved, verifying that the approval workflow ran end-to-end.

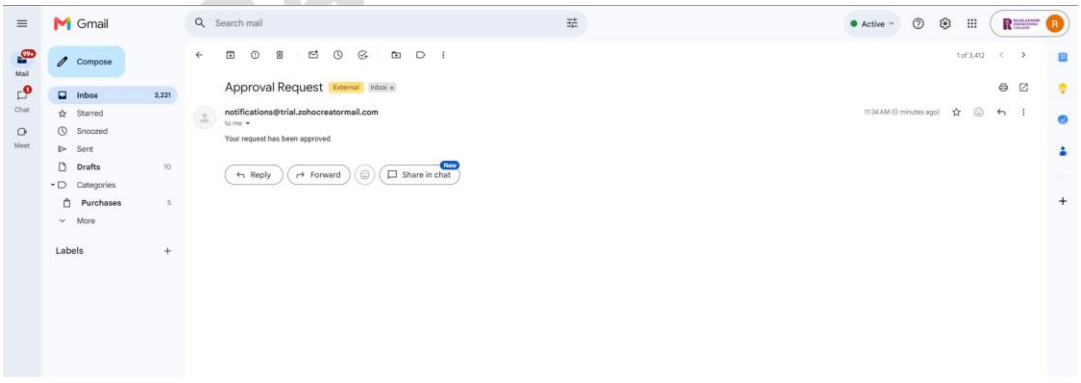


Fig. 8 – Gmail notification confirming the approved 'Event Registration' request